01 · Project brief & scope

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Corner Sofa

Detailed website development requirements

> I want a complete UK sofa e-commerce website based on my existing website and design references. Customers must be able to browse sofas, choose colours, manage their basket, arrange delivery and place orders. I must be able to manage the shop from a secure admin dashboard.

Scope rules

- Exclude AI agents, chatbots, Alashi, and agent-specific pages, workflows and integrations.
- Retain the product colour-preview and room-preview tools described here as customer/shop features.
- Use the existing site as the visual and functional reference. This document describes the requested outcome; it is not a claim that every feature already exists.
- Deliver working customer and administrator journeys with persistent data, not demonstration-only forms.
- Use GBP (£), UK address terminology and clear customer-facing English.

Payment interpretation to confirm

Cash on delivery is explicitly required. “Card available at delivery” is interpreted provisionally as **card on delivery**. Online card payment remains part of the earlier brief. The reference to an account number is provisionally treated as **business bank details for an optional bank-transfer payment**. These are different methods and must not be silently substituted for one another.

No bank details have been supplied. Do not invent them or ask customers for bank account numbers in the delivery form. The business owner must confirm the intended methods before payment implementation.

Document map

1. Scope · 2. Design and pages · 3. Products · 4. Basket · 5. Delivery fields · 6. Postcodes and delivery · 7. Payments · 8. Order handling · 9. Swatches and room tools · 10. Admin and engineering · 11. Acceptance and handover · 12. Decisions and sources

02 · Design, navigation & website pages

Visual requirements

- Premium furniture-store appearance with large, clear product photographs, generous spacing and a consistent layout.
- Palette: warm cream #F7F1DE, sage #B0BA99, terracotta #9D6638, espresso #4E220F and muted gold #C5A880.
- Use the existing Assistant typography, tasteful frosted-glass panels, soft shadows and restrained animation. Maintain readable text contrast.
- Responsive layouts for phone, tablet and desktop. Menus, filters, galleries and checkout must work by touch and keyboard.
- Persistent access to products and basket; visible basket quantity. Include contact, delivery and policy links in the footer.

Page / area	Required content and behaviour
Homepage	Brand introduction, prominent sofa photography, categories, featured products and links to shopping, swatches and room preview.
Catalogue	Category, fabric and price filters; meaningful empty state; clear prices and product images.
Product detail	Gallery, description, dimensions, variants, price, availability, delivery information and add-to-basket action.
Basket / checkout	Editable basket, delivery details, delivery choice, payment choice, final review and confirmation.
Service pages	Swatches, showroom appointments and Try in your room.
Information pages	About, contact, reviews, delivery information, size guide, FAQs, blog, privacy and terms.

Content rules

Use owner-supplied or approved contact details, policies, delivery times, photographs and copy. Do not fabricate reviews, stock scarcity, warranties or delivery promises. Reviews labelled verified must have a supporting verification process. Contact forms must actually reach a configured destination and show submission failures clearly.

03 · Products, variants & colour previews

Product data

- Each product needs a stable ID, name, category, description, image gallery, GBP price and availability.
- Include dimensions with units, fabric/material, size options and colour variants where applicable.
- Categories include two-seater, three-seater, corner and recliner. For directional corner sofas, show left/right orientation clearly where sold.
- Maintain separate variant IDs so stock, price, colour and images remain attached to the correct selection.
- Allow an optional original price for genuine discounts. Do not add sample discounts or extra colours automatically.

Customer behaviour

- Selecting a colour must update its label, selected state and matching product photograph.
- Require selection of any mandatory size, orientation or colour before adding to the basket.
- Show unavailable combinations clearly and prevent orders for variants the business does not sell.
- Display the selected variant consistently in the basket, checkout, confirmation and admin order.
- If a product changes while in a basket, explain the change before the customer confirms an order.

Admin colour-photo workflow

1. Upload a main sofa photograph and enter the product details.
2. Add a colour name and colour value.
3. Upload a dedicated colour photograph or generate a colour preview from the main photograph.
4. Review the result, retry or replace it, then explicitly save.
5. Show the saved variant to shoppers and preserve its image after restart or deployment.

Generated previews must preserve sofa shape, shading and texture as far as practical, and carry a visible “Colour preview” label. The administrator must be able to remove a colour. Existing orders must retain a snapshot of what was purchased even if the catalogue later changes.

04 · Basket requirements

Basket contents

Every line must show the sofa name, selected photograph, colour, size/orientation where applicable, unit price, quantity and line total. Different variants of the same sofa must appear as separate lines.

- Provide increase/decrease controls and an editable quantity; accept positive whole numbers only within allowed stock limits.
- Provide a clear remove action. Recalculate totals after every change.
- Keep basket contents after refresh and a later return on the same browser. Do not promise cross-device persistence without customer accounts.
- Show a useful empty-basket message and a link back to products.
- Prevent unavailable products from proceeding; explain price or stock changes without silently substituting another sofa.
- Allow guest checkout. Preserve basket and valid form entries when payment fails or the customer returns to edit an item.

Price breakdown

Item	Rule
Products subtotal	Sum of the current accepted line totals.
Discount	Only discounts actually configured by the business; label clearly.
Delivery	Calculate from postcode, service and any disclosed access charges. Before known, show “Calculated after postcode”, not a false £0.
Total	Show the full payable total before placing an order. Display tax treatment according to the business configuration.
Due now / due on delivery	Show separately for each payment choice. No deposit is assumed unless the owner specifies one.

Example only — not agreed business pricing

Sofa £799 + delivery £49 = **£848 total**. For full cash on delivery: **£0 due now; £848 due on delivery**. For full online card payment: **£848 due now; £0 due on delivery**. For card on delivery: **£0 due now; £848 due by card on delivery**.

The server must recalculate prices, quantities, discounts and delivery charges before creating the order. Never trust totals supplied by the browser.

05 · Exactly what to ask the customer

Use the label **Postcode**, not “potcode” or “ZIP code”. Mark optional fields clearly. The requirements below are proposed business checkout rules.

Field	Required?	Validation / purpose
Full name	Yes	Recipient/contact name. Allow real-world names, spaces, apostrophes and hyphens.
Email address	Yes	Order confirmation and updates; trim spaces and check sensible email format.
Contact phone number	Yes	Delivery coordination. Accept international prefixes; do not require exactly 11 digits for every customer.
Postcode	Yes	Normalise and check format, address match and delivery coverage separately.
Address line 1	Yes	Building number/name and street as appropriate. Allow named buildings without a number.
Flat / unit and address line 2	When applicable	Make clear that customers in flats must include their flat/unit identifier.
Town / city	Yes	Populate from lookup where available; allow manual entry.
County	No	Do not block checkout because a county is missing.
Country	Yes / preset	United Kingdom for the initial UK checkout; service-area rules still apply.
Property type	Yes	House, flat or other, to plan sofa delivery.
Floor and lift access	Conditional	Ask for flats or upper-floor delivery; identify whether a suitable lift is available.
Access restrictions	Yes / yes-no	Ask about narrow entrances, stairs, parking or restricted access. Show a notes field if yes.
Delivery notes	No	Useful directions or access instructions; advise against including payment details.
Delivery service / slot	Service: yes	Show eligible services. Only offer a confirmed slot if scheduling supports it.
Payment method	Yes	Show enabled, eligible methods with due-now and outstanding amounts.
Billing address	Conditional	Default to delivery address; collect a different address when needed for online payment.
Terms acceptance	Yes	Link the approved terms. Any marketing opt-in must be separate and optional.

Do not collect: customer bank account number, sort code, PIN or card details in delivery fields. Online card entry belongs in the payment provider’s secure interface.

06 · Postcode checks & delivery rules

Three different checks

1. **Format:** trim whitespace, accept lowercase input and missing separator spaces, then display a normalised uppercase postcode with a space before its final three characters. Use a maintained UK postcode validator. A pattern match is only a format check.
2. **Address:** use an agreed address-lookup provider to retrieve matching addresses; ask the customer to select the complete address. A postcode can cover multiple addresses, so postcode alone is insufficient.
3. **Shop coverage:** check the selected postcode against the business's delivery zones and calculate available services and charges. A real postcode does not mean this shop delivers there.

Recommended checkout flow

Enter postcode → Find address → Select full address → Check/edit details → Enter access information → View available delivery and total → Choose payment → Review and place order.

- Provide "Enter address manually" when lookup fails or the address is missing. Mark manually entered/unverified addresses for review where necessary.
- If the lookup service is unavailable, say so; do not tell the customer that their postcode is invalid.
- A manual address must still pass the delivery-zone check. If coverage cannot be established, offer an enquiry or pending review rather than an unqualified delivery promise.
- If the address is edited, invalidate its previous verified status and recheck coverage and charges.
- Support new-build and missing-address cases through a clear contact/review route.

Messages the engineer must implement

Situation	Example message
Blank / invalid format	"Enter a valid UK postcode."
No matching address	"We couldn't find this address. Check your postcode or enter the address manually."
Outside delivery area	"We don't currently offer standard delivery to this postcode. Contact us for a quote."
Lookup outage	"Address lookup is temporarily unavailable. You can enter your address manually."

Configure standard, express and room-of-choice delivery only where the business can supply them. Confirm coverage for Northern Ireland, islands, Highlands and other exceptions. Obtain owner-approved prices, lead times, access surcharges and failed-delivery rules.

Address design basis: ONS address-entry guidance [S1] and Royal Mail Postcode Finder [S2]. Delivery zones and the review policy above are project requirements, not Royal Mail service guarantees.

07 · Payment methods & account details

Method	Checkout and delivery behaviour
Cash on delivery Required	Place an unpaid order without requesting card details. Show the full amount due at delivery, any eligibility restrictions and the owner-approved cash/change policy. Confirmation must say payment is outstanding.
Card on delivery Provisional interpretation	Place an unpaid order and state that the customer pays using the driver's approved card terminal. Confirm terminal availability before offering this method. Do not collect a card number at checkout for this method.
Card online Earlier brief	Use secure provider-hosted card entry. Confirm payment from the provider on the server. Handle decline, cancellation, authentication and retry without creating duplicate paid orders.
Bank transfer Optional; confirm intent	Display verified business bank details, exact amount and unique order reference. Keep payment pending until receipt is checked. Agree whether transfer is required before dispatch or at delivery.

If the business supplies an account number

For a UK bank-transfer option, the owner should provide **account holder/payee name, bank name, sort code and account number**. The site should additionally show the amount, order reference and payment deadline. These are the business's receiving details, not customer delivery information. The owner must verify them before publication.

- Restrict bank-detail editing to authorised administration and record changes. Do not put invented or sample bank details into the live checkout.
- A transfer screenshot, customer statement or "I have paid" button must not mark an order paid. Require an authorised receipt check or verified banking integration.
- For card-on-delivery failures, leave payment outstanding and follow the owner-approved alternative-payment or redelivery process.
- Record method, amount, transaction/reference, staff member and timestamp when money is received.

Payment data

Keep payment secrets on the server. Store provider references and limited display details only where necessary. Never store CVV or PIN, and never send card details through delivery notes, email or admin forms. PCI SSC prohibits retaining card verification codes after authorisation [S3].

Klarna remains conditional on the business account and provider configuration. Do not display an unavailable payment method as if it works.

08 · Checkout, orders & delivery completion

Final review before submission

Show all products and selected variants, quantities, contact details, full address, access notes, chosen delivery service, payment method, total, amount due now and outstanding balance. Let customers edit each section. Use a button label matching the action, such as “Place order — pay on delivery” or “Pay £848 securely”.

Keep two separate statuses

Order / fulfilment	Payment
Pending confirmation → Confirmed → Processing → Dispatched → Delivered. Also support Cancelled and Delivery failed.	Unpaid / Due on delivery → Pending verification → Paid. Also support Failed, Partially refunded and Refunded where relevant.

A delivered order is not automatically paid. A paid order is not automatically delivered. Staff must see both statuses and the remaining balance clearly.

Order creation and confirmation

- Create a unique order number and preserve a snapshot of products, prices, delivery charges and customer selections.
- Prevent double-clicks, repeated requests and repeated payment notifications from duplicating the order or payment.
- Show confirmation on the website and send an email through a configured email service. Show outstanding payment clearly for pay-on-delivery orders.
- If notification delivery fails, keep the valid order, record the failure and allow a resend.
- Do not mark online payments paid merely because the browser reaches a success page; verify the provider result.

At delivery

1. Staff open the order and verify the recipient, address, items, method and balance due.
2. Collect cash, process the card terminal payment, or verify the transfer according to the selected method.
3. Record the actual successful payment; failed or unverified attempts leave the balance outstanding.
4. Record delivery completion or a failed-delivery reason separately.
5. Provide an order/payment receipt or confirmation reflecting what was actually collected.

Refunds and cancellations must retain their history. Define stock reservation, cancellation timing, cash reconciliation, return handling and delivery-failure rules with the owner. Do not remove historical orders when a product is deleted.

09 · Swatches, appointments & room preview

Fabric swatches

- Allow selection of up to four fabrics with clear names and thumbnails.
- Collect name, email and full postal address including postcode; request phone only if operationally needed.
- Validate required fields, save the request and display/send confirmation.
- Provide admin statuses: pending, processing, shipped and delivered. Keep requested fabric names in the record.

Showroom booking

- Show actual showrooms and available dates/times. Prevent booking the same limited-capacity slot beyond its capacity.
- Collect name, email, phone, showroom, date/time and optional notes. Display the local appointment time clearly.
- Confirm the request and distinguish requested appointments from confirmed bookings.
- Admin can confirm, complete or cancel; communicate changes through configured notifications.

Try in your room

1. Customer uploads a JPG, PNG or WebP room photograph.
2. Customer marks four points around the wall space; lower points indicate the floor/contact area.
3. Customer selects a sofa and saved colour from the current shop catalogue.
4. Display the complete sofa cutout, including loose cushions, level and front-facing within the selected space.
5. Allow size, horizontal/vertical position, wall coverage, side-gap and floor-placement adjustments.
6. Allow PNG download and add the chosen sofa/colour to the basket.

Desktop should provide clear product selection, central preview and placement controls. Adapt controls for mobile touch use. Keep room photos in the browser and clear them when the customer leaves or refreshes. Explain that the result is a visual preview and does not guarantee physical fit.

Failure and persistence rules

Handle unsupported images, oversized files and preview-generation errors with useful retry guidance. Persist saved product previews and sofa cutouts in deployment-compatible storage. Customers must not need administrator access to use the room planner.

10 · Administration & engineering requirements

Admin dashboard

- Secure login/logout and server-side access checks for every private page and management endpoint.
- Dashboard summaries for products, orders, outstanding payments, swatch requests and appointments.
- Create/edit/delete products; manage categories, descriptions, dimensions, images, variants, prices, discounts and stock.
- Search/filter orders by order number, date, customer, payment method, payment status and fulfilment status.
- View delivery address, phone, access instructions, line items and amount due. Update delivery and payment records independently.
- Manage swatch and appointment statuses. Confirm destructive actions and preserve business history.
- Provide controlled settings or documented configuration for delivery areas, charges, enabled payment methods and verified business details.

Implementation

Use Next.js, React, TypeScript and Tailwind CSS, consistent with the existing project. Use PostgreSQL for persistent business data and durable image/object storage for uploads and generated assets. Vercel is the intended hosting target; do not rely on temporary server filesystem storage for live orders or images.

- Keep server credentials out of frontend code and version control. Validate inputs and enforce permissions on the server.
- Use secure admin sessions, protected mutations and upload restrictions. Record important order, payment and bank-detail changes.
- Make order creation, stock handling and payment processing resilient to retries and concurrent purchases.
- Optimise images, layouts and loading. Provide labelled fields, keyboard navigation, visible focus and readable contrast.
- Provide page titles/descriptions, sitemap, robots.txt and accurate product/business structured data.
- Implement clear empty, loading, success and failure states. Do not lose completed customer input on a recoverable error.
- Set up backups, error logging and a documented restore procedure; avoid logging full payment details or unnecessary customer data.

Use owner-approved privacy, terms, returns and cookie content. Analytics, if enabled, must follow the approved consent configuration. Agree third-party service costs and account ownership before launch.

11 · Acceptance checks & delivery package

The engineer must demonstrate these outcomes using test data and payment test facilities before launch.

Check	Passing result
Product and variant	Chosen colour, size, photograph and price stay correct from product page through order.
Basket	Refresh preserves items; edits recalculate totals; invalid quantities and unavailable variants are blocked.
Postcode	Lowercase/spaceless input is normalised; invalid input is explained; full address can be selected.
Address fallback	Missing addresses and lookup outages allow manual entry/review without bypassing coverage checks.
Delivery area	Supported areas receive correct charges; excluded areas do not receive false delivery promises.
Cash on delivery	Order saves without a card; amount due remains outstanding until collection is recorded.
Card on delivery	If enabled, order remains unpaid until a successful terminal payment is recorded.
Online card	Success, decline, cancellation and repeated callbacks produce correct states without duplicate payment.
Bank transfer	If enabled, verified business details and reference display; customer claims do not mark payment paid.
Order updates	Delivery and payment statuses remain independent; receipts show accurate balances.
Admin protection	Signed-out users cannot read private customer records or change catalogue/orders through APIs.
Other journeys	Swatches, appointment capacity, room preview, PNG export and basket handoff work.
Persistence	Orders, images and settings survive restart and redeployment; backup restoration is demonstrated.
Responsive experience	Key journeys work on phone and desktop with no clipped controls or unusable forms.

Handover package

Provide full source code, local setup steps, environment-variable template without secrets, database migrations, storage setup, deployment instructions, owner-controlled service accounts, admin guide, test results and a list of any agreed outstanding items. Supply a working local build and deployed site. Explain ongoing hosting, lookup, email, storage and payment service costs.

12 · Owner decisions & verified references

Confirm before implementing the affected feature

1. **Payment meaning:** Is the second required method card on delivery, online card, or bank transfer? Should multiple methods be offered?
2. **Account number:** Confirm this means the business's receiving account. Supply verified payee name, bank, sort code and account number only if transfers are offered.
3. **Collection rules:** Full payment at delivery or a deposit? Cash limits/change policy? Card terminals and supported methods? Transfer deadline and receipt-verification process?
4. **Delivery:** Exact postcode zones, exclusions, charges, lead times, service types, access limits, surcharges and failed-delivery procedure.
5. **Business content:** Legal/trading name, contact details, showroom addresses, product data, approved reviews and policies.
6. **Services:** Owner accounts for hosting, database, image storage, email, address lookup and payment provider. Confirm the budget and account ownership.

These are unresolved configuration choices, not permission to invent business rules. The engineer can build the agreed catalogue, basket, forms and administration while obtaining these decisions.

What was verified

"Postcode" is the correct UK field. Address lookup and manual entry are established address-collection approaches. A valid-looking postcode does not by itself prove a complete delivery address or shop coverage. No particular customer postcode was supplied, so this document does not certify an individual address.

[S1] Office for National Statistics — Ask users for: Addresses
https://service-manual.ons.gov.uk/design-system/patterns/addresses
Supports the address-selection/editing/manual-entry approach. Shop-specific field requirements and delivery rules are specified in this brief.

[S2] Royal Mail — Postcode Finder
https://www.royalmail.com/find-a-postcode
Reference for checking UK addresses and postcodes. Use an appropriately licensed lookup integration for the website; do not treat the public finder as an unrestricted API.

[S3] PCI Security Standards Council — FAQ 1319
https://www.pcisecuritystandards.org/faqs/1319/
Confirms card verification codes must not be retained after authorisation.

Sources checked 15 September 2026. Feature baseline: the owner-approved earlier brief and the existing project README. This document expands that brief with explicit checkout requirements and marks ambiguous payment details for confirmation.